

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Project Idea

The project idea is to develop an automated IT procurement workflow for **standard laptop orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer**. The system will automatically create and assign a catalog task to the Hardware team after the laptop request receives approval.

2. Problem Identification

The existing standard laptop procurement process involves manual activities that can cause delays and configuration-related oversights. Requests may require additional configuration before the laptop can be delivered to the user, resulting in increased waiting time and additional workload for the IT procurement team.

3. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is to automate the procurement workflow through **ServiceNow Flow Designer**.

The proposed workflow is:

**User requests Standard Laptop → Service Request
→ Approval → Automated Catalog Task →
Hardware Team Assignment → Laptop
Configuration → Request Completion**

Once the request is approved, Flow Designer automatically creates a Catalog Task with:

- **Short Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Assignment Group:** Hardware
- **Approval:** Approved

This removes the need for the procurement team to manually create and assign the configuration task.

4. Brainstormed Ideas

During the ideation stage, the following ideas were considered:

1. Automate standard laptop request processing.
2. Automatically create a Catalog Task after approval.
3. Automatically assign the task to the Hardware team.
4. Automatically update the task description.

5. Connect the automation to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
6. Reduce manual intervention in IT procurement.
7. Improve laptop configuration turnaround time.
8. Provide a smoother experience for employees requesting laptops.

5. Selected Idea

The selected idea is to create a **ServiceNow Flow Designer automation** named “**Standard Laptop Task.**”

The flow will use the **Service Catalog trigger** and the **Create Catalog Task** action. The created task will be assigned to the **Hardware** group after the request is approved.

6. Expected Benefits

The proposed idea is expected to:

- Reduce manual work.
- Minimize delays in laptop configuration.
- Reduce errors and missed configuration tasks.

- Automatically allocate tasks to the appropriate Hardware team.
- Improve IT resource utilization.
- Reduce user waiting time.
- Improve the overall efficiency of IT procurement.

These expected benefits align with the project's stated objectives of reducing manual intervention, improving resource utilization, and enhancing IT procurement efficiency.

7. Ideation Outcome

The ideation phase resulted in a clear automation concept: **use ServiceNow Flow Designer to automatically generate and assign a laptop configuration task whenever an approved Standard Laptop request is processed.**

This concept forms the basis for the subsequent implementation phases, including flow creation, flow assignment to the Standard Laptop catalog item, and testing through the Service Catalog.